Class Practical Reflection

Paper 2 Preparation | First Assessment 2027

Name: _____ Practical: _____

Instructions: Reflect on your completed class practical using the questions below. Write your answers in your notebook, using specific examples from your investigation and appropriate psychological terminology. The examples are intended to guide your thinking, not provide answers to copy.

Part 1 – Understanding Your Practical

1. Aim and Research Method

What was your research question, and which specific research method did you use? Explain why this method was suitable for investigating your topic.

Think about: What were you trying to understand or measure? Why was your chosen method appropriate?

2. Sample and Sampling

How many participants were involved, who were they, and how were they recruited? Identify the sampling technique used.

Example: Selecting available classmates is opportunity sampling; recruiting people who respond to an invitation is volunteer sampling.

3. Procedure

Describe how you conducted your practical, from preparation to data analysis.

Include: Materials or questions prepared, instructions given to participants, what participants did, how data were recorded, and how the findings were analysed.

4. Findings

What were your main findings? Give one specific example from your collected data and explain what it suggests about your research question.

Remember: Describe what your evidence actually shows rather than making unsupported claims about causation.

Part 2 – Evaluating Your Practical

5. Bias

Identify two possible sources of bias in your investigation. For each, explain how it could have occurred, how it might have influenced your findings, and how its influence could be reduced.

Think about: Researcher expectations, leading questions, participants changing their behaviour, social desirability or sampling bias.

Example: Participants answering questions about their study habits might exaggerate how much they study to appear hardworking.

6. Methodological Limitations

Identify one specific weakness in how your investigation was conducted. Explain how it could have affected your findings and suggest a realistic improvement.

Think about: Was your sample too narrow? Were instructions inconsistent? Was something difficult to measure? Could the data have been interpreted differently?

Example: Interviewing only students from one class might provide a limited range of experiences. Including students from different year groups could broaden the perspectives represented.

7. Ethical Considerations

Identify two ethical considerations relevant to your investigation. Explain why each mattered and what you actually did to address it.

Think about: Informed consent, right to withdraw, confidentiality, protection from harm and debriefing.

Example: When discussing sensitive personal experiences, protecting participants' identities and ensuring they can decline questions may be particularly important.

Part 3 – Paper 2 Examination Skills

8. Comparing Research Methods

Compare and contrast the interview or focus group used in your practical with an experiment.

Explain **two differences and one similarity**, including why each matters for conducting psychological research.

Think about: Manipulation of variables, researcher control, data collection, causality and ethical considerations.

Example: An experiment manipulates an independent variable to investigate its effect on a dependent variable, whereas an interview explores participants' experiences without manipulating variables.

Make direct comparisons rather than describing each method separately.

9. Designing an Observation

Design an observation to investigate the same general topic as your practical.

Include:

- **Aim:** What observable behaviour would you investigate?
- **Sample and setting:** Who would you observe, how would you recruit them, and where?
- **Type:** Naturalistic or controlled? Participant or non-participant? Overt or covert?
- **Behaviour:** What specific behaviours would you record, and how would you define them?
- **Recording:** Would you use a checklist, frequency count or time sampling?
- **Procedure:** How long would observations last, and exactly how would they be conducted?
- **Ethics:** How would you protect participants?

Example: If your practical explored academic stress, you could observe behaviours during study sessions, such as how frequently students check their phones or take breaks. These behaviours do not directly measure how stressed someone feels.

Your design should be detailed enough for another researcher to replicate.

Part 4 – Final Reflection

10. What Would You Change?

If you repeated your practical, what is **one methodological decision** you would change? Explain what you would do differently and how this could improve the quality of your findings.

Examples: Improving question wording, recruiting a broader sample, standardising instructions or recording data more systematically.